Era 8: Westward Expansion

1803–1860 · APUSH Period 4 / 5 · Lessons 18–19

Name _____ Due _____

This is your study guide for the whole era. Complete each lesson section as you study it, using your class notes and textbook: read the AP topic(s) listed for the lesson in your textbook, define every term, person and event in your own words, then answer the Key Question in 3–5 sentences with specific evidence. Each lesson is checked and stamped in class; the whole guide is collected and graded at the end of the era. **Before the end-of-era test:** finish the Era Wrap-Up, then reread the whole guide. Fix or add anything in a different color.

Lesson 18 *Manifest Destiny · Texas · Oregon*

5.1 (LO A): Explain the context in which sectional conflict emerged from 1844 to 1877.
5.2 (LO B): Explain the causes and effects of westward expansion from 1844 to 1877.

Read (AP topics in your textbook): Topic 5.1 *Contextualizing Period 5* · Topic 5.2 *Manifest Destiny*

STAMP

Terms

Define it in your own words and explain why it matters.

1. **Manifest Destiny**

2. **the Alamo**

3. **annexation**

4. **"54°40′ or Fight"**

5. **mountain men**

People

Who they were and why they matter.

6. **John L. O'Sullivan**

7. **Stephen F. Austin**

8. **Sam Houston**

9. **Antonio López de Santa Anna**

10. **James K. Polk**

11. **Brigham Young**

Events

What happened and why it matters.

12. **American settlers move into Texas (1820s)**

13. **Santa Fe Trail opens (1821)**

14. **Texas Revolution & independence (1836)**

15. **Oregon Trail migration (1840s)**

16. **Texas annexed (1845)**

17. Oregon Treaty (1846)

18. Mormon migration to Salt Lake (1846–47)

19. Commodore Perry opens Japan (1853–54)

Lesson 18 · Key Question *Manifest Destiny · Texas · Oregon*

5.1 (LO A): Explain the context in which sectional conflict emerged from 1844 to 1877.
5.2 (LO B): Explain the causes and effects of westward expansion from 1844 to 1877.

Explain how the idea of Manifest Destiny and economic opportunity drove American settlement and expansion into Texas, Oregon, and the West in the 1830s and 1840s.

Answer in 3–5 sentences. Make a clear claim, support it with at least two specific pieces of evidence from this lesson, and explain how the evidence supports your claim.

Lesson 19 *Mexican-American War · Gold Rush · Wilmot Proviso*

5.3 (LO C): Explain the causes and effects of the Mexican–American War.

Read (AP topic in your textbook): Topic 5.3 *The Mexican–American War*

STAMP

Terms

Define it in your own words and explain why it matters.

20. Mexican Cession

21. Wilmot Proviso

22. Californios

23. Nueces River vs. Rio Grande boundary

24. Chinese immigrants in the Gold Rush

People

Who they were and why they matter.

25. Zachary Taylor

26. Winfield Scott

27. John C. Frémont

Events

What happened and why it matters.

28. **Mexican-American War (1846–48)**

29. **Bear Flag Revolt (1846)**

30. **Treaty of Guadalupe Hidalgo (1848)**

31. **gold discovered at Sutter's Mill (1848)**

32. **California Gold Rush (1849)**

33. **California statehood (1850)**

34. **Gadsden Purchase (1853)**

Lesson 19 · Key Question *Mexican-American War · Gold Rush · Wilmot Proviso*

5.3 (LO C): Explain the causes and effects of the Mexican–American War.

Explain the causes and effects of the Mexican-American War, including how the Mexican Cession intensified the debate over the expansion of slavery.

Answer in 3–5 sentences. Make a clear claim, support it with at least two specific pieces of evidence from this lesson, and explain how the evidence supports your claim.

Era Wrap-Up *complete before the end-of-era test*

Growth of the United States, 1845–1853

Territory	How it was acquired	Year	Controversy it caused
Texas			
Oregon Country			
Mexican Cession			
Gadsden Purchase			

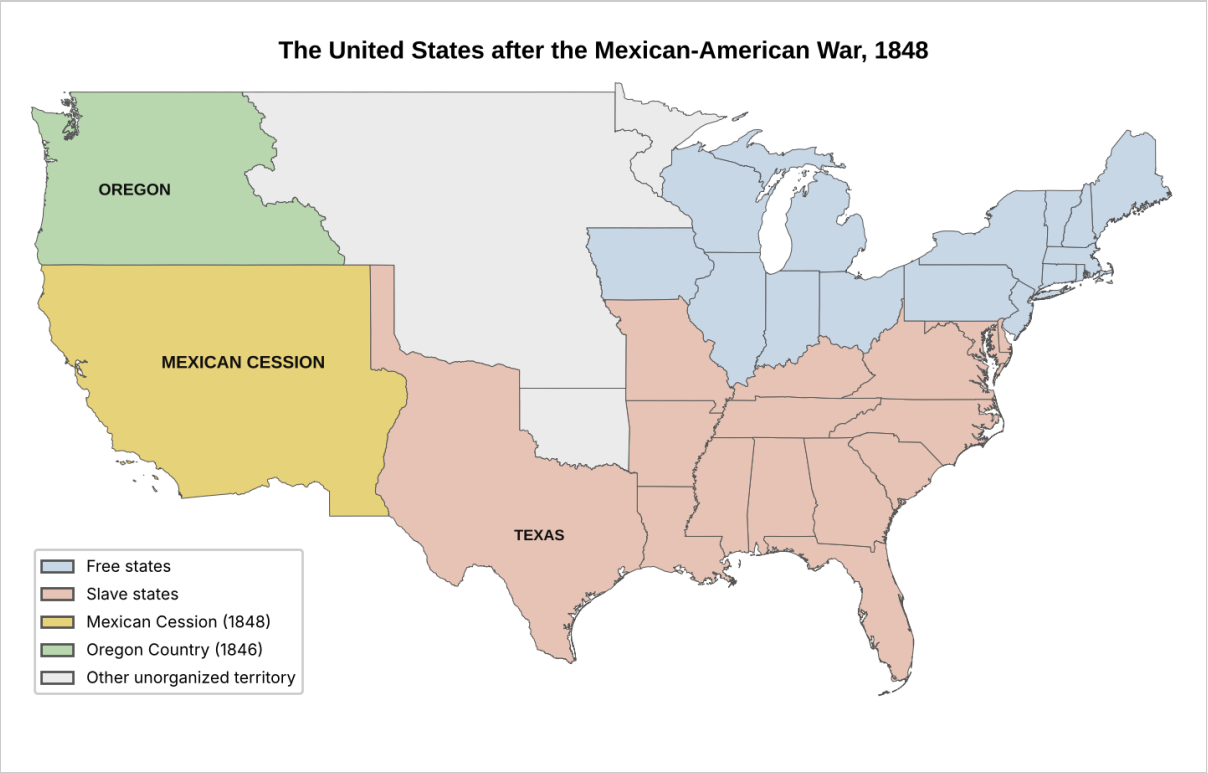
Debating the Mexican-American War

Group	Position on the war	Main reasons
President Polk & expansionist Democrats		
Whigs in Congress		
Abolitionists & antislavery northerners		
Southern slaveholders		

AP Short-Answer Practice

Answer a, b and c. Each part is scored on its own, so answer each one directly in 1–3 sentences with specific historical evidence.

Map: The United States after the Mexican-American War, August 1848



Map drawn for this guide from state and territory boundaries in the Newberry Library's Atlas of Historical County Boundaries.

a. Briefly describe ONE change in the territory of the United States shown on the map.

b. Briefly explain ONE cause of the United States' acquisition of the Mexican Cession OR the Oregon Country.

c. Briefly explain ONE debate or conflict between 1846 and 1850 caused by the acquisition of the territory shown on the map.

DBQ Practice · Sourcing: Intended Audience

PROMPT

Evaluate the relative importance of the causes of United States territorial expansion from 1844 to 1860.

Your task: Write 2–3 sentences that explain how the intended audience of the document on this page is relevant to an argument that responds to the prompt.

What earns the point: To earn credit, explain how the document's intended audience shaped what it says and why that matters to your argument. Simply naming the audience does not earn credit; you must explain how the author wrote with that audience in mind.

James K. Polk, special message to Congress on relations with Mexico (war message), May 11, 1846

The cup of forbearance had been exhausted even before the recent information from the frontier of the Del Norte. But now, after reiterated menaces, Mexico has passed the boundary of the United States, has invaded our territory and shed American blood upon the American soil. She has proclaimed that hostilities have commenced, and that the two nations are now at war.

As war exists, and, notwithstanding all our efforts to avoid it, exists by the act of Mexico herself, we are called upon by every consideration of duty and patriotism to vindicate with decision the honor, the rights, and the interests of our country.

Text: Teaching American History (Ashbrook Center). Excerpt. "The Del Norte" is the Rio Grande.

Connect forward — *Era 9 preview: the Mexican Cession reopened the question the Missouri Compromise had seemed to settle. Watch how the fight over slavery in the new territories pulls the Union apart in the 1850s.*